

Young Author's Anthology Grading Rubric

This rubric will be used to assess submitted stories across four key categories: Plot, Prose, Impact, and Characters. Each category is worth a maximum of 4 points. Judges must also summarize stories and their thoughts/additional comments/reasons below the table for stating the story should be discarded or advanced for further judging.

Title of story: _____ Author: _____

Criteria	4 - Excellent	3 - Proficient	2 - Developing	1 - Needs Improvement
Plot	Story is highly original, engaging, and creative, with well-developed themes and characters. Everything harmonizes to make a cohesive narrative.	Story is engaging and clear with discernible themes and characters. Demonstrates a good understanding of the topic but has a few conflicting narrative beats.	Story is present but has plot points that could be expanded on; Demonstrates some understanding of the topic with huge potential for the story.	Story is confusing or undeveloped; Demonstrates understanding of the content but could improve greatly on execution.
Prose	Transitions are seamless and there are few grammar errors. Descriptions are unique and memorable. Vocab is not graded.	Sentence structure is mostly clear with some awkward sentences. Descriptions are superfluous but still well - done. Vocab is not graded.	Structure is somewhat fragmented or disjointed, making it occasionally difficult to follow. Transitions are weak or abrupt. Vocab is not graded.	The story is difficult to follow due to large sentence structure issues. Vocab is not graded.
Impact	The theme and message of the story left a considerable impression on the judge. The use of plot, character, setting, and conflict result in an incredibly engaging read.	The theme and message of the story have large potential and the use of plot, character, setting, and conflict grab the reader's attention most of the time. Executing the theme may be a bit weaker, however.	The theme and message are understandable if a bit simplistic. The use of plot, character, setting, and conflict was cohesive but ultimately unclear in terms of the bigger picture these elements attempt to portray.	The theme and message are unclear or not present. Plot, character, setting, and conflict all feel superficial rather than building to a larger central idea.
Characters	Characters are engaging with considerable on-page presence. They grab the reader's attention with either witty dialogue or memorable actions. Plot is highly character driven and the two, plot and characters, enhance one another.	Characters are engaging but are not always presented to their fullest potential. They grab the reader's attention with either witty dialogue or memorable actions. Plot and characterizations sometimes conflict but mostly harmonize.	Characters are interesting but motivations do not coincide well with actions or the connection is unclear. They are distinguishable but could use work to make them more prominent.	Characters have large potential to be fleshed out beyond their use in the story and some dialogue or actions feel confusing and out-of-character.

Total Score: __/16

Additional Comments: